

KEN CLEMONS

Sales Portfolio | Enterprise Account Executive | Central US | 314-496-7341 | ken.clemons@gmail.com

EIGHT YEARS SELLING COMMERCIAL OPEN SOURCE

January 2014 through January 2022 I sold open source software and nothing else. Three vendors, three different layers of the stack, one commercial model underneath all of it.

- Alfresco, 2014 to 2017. Content services and process automation. Community build available free, enterprise subscription sold on support, compliance and audit trail. VP seat over the region, three sellers under me, \$1.5M carried personally against a \$4M team figure, closed at 146 percent with the P&L on my desk.
- Red Hat, 2017 to 2020. Enterprise Linux, Kubernetes, containers and infrastructure automation into Global 500 accounts, every deal contested by a free alternative somewhere in the stack. Quotas of \$7M, \$5M and \$3.5M, cleared each year at 160 percent, 128 percent and 137 percent.
- Couchbase, 2020 to 2022. Distributed NoSQL, Community Edition free, enterprise subscription sold on operational risk at scale. 135 percent of quota through the pre-IPO and IPO years.

Since 2022 I have carried cloud networking at Cloudflare, network visibility at Gigamon and an agentic threat intelligence platform at Analyst1. Different products, same buyer set: infrastructure, platform engineering and security leadership at large enterprises.

HOW I SELL AGAINST A FREE VERSION

Anyone can download the community build. That reality shaped how I run discovery, and it is a muscle proprietary sellers never develop.

- Find who owns the patch. I ask which named person is accountable when a critical CVE drops on a holiday weekend. The answer is often nobody, and that is the opening.
- Price the hidden headcount. Self-managing an open source stack is real engineering salary. I build the model with the customer, using their own loaded cost per engineer.
- Bring in audit and compliance early. Certified builds, provenance, lifecycle windows and indemnification matter to people the technical champion has never introduced me to. I find them in week two.
- Let the champion keep the free tier. Development and test staying on the community build is fine. Production, regulated workloads and anything with a customer promise attached is where the subscription belongs.
- Model the renewal from day one. Subscription revenue lives or dies at renewal, so I write the success criteria into the first agreement.

THE PROCUREMENT ADVANTAGE

Before I ever carried a quota I worked in corporate procurement. I know how a vendor package gets scored, what sourcing does with a proposal after it lands and which clauses draw redlines. In practice this means the business case arrives in the format finance already uses, pricing structure is on the table before procurement asks, and quarter end does not disappear into paperwork I could have started in month one.

TERRITORY BUILDING WITHOUT INBOUND

Every patch I have ever been handed was empty. The method has stayed consistent.

Segment. Rank the named list on observable signal ahead of raw revenue. Job postings naming specific technologies, earnings call commentary on infrastructure cost, migration announcements, regulatory pressure in the vertical, and what partners are already hearing.

Reach. Outbound leads with a hypothesis about that specific account and a specific stack. At Cloudflare this produced \$4M across 35 target prospects with zero inbound support.

Qualify. MEDDPICC applied honestly, including the parts that disqualify a deal. I would rather kill an opportunity in month one than carry it in the forecast for two quarters.

Prove. Field engineering runs the technical validation against success criteria the customer wrote down before we started. I have never asked an SE to demo without an agreed metric.

Close. Mutual close plan in Salesforce from first qualified call, with security review, procurement and legal running in parallel tracks.

SELECTED WINS

- Centene, Red Hat. Displaced an incumbent to sign \$5M annually, services included, with finance leadership and legal both at the table.
- Red Hat new logo run across payer, financial services, healthcare and industrials: Express Scripts, Mastercard, Cerner, Edward Jones, Emerson, Anthem, Enterprise Holdings, BJC, Panera Bread, Mercy and Ascension.
- Couchbase net-new set at 135 percent of quota through the IPO: Post Holdings, Paycom, OG&E, FirstEnergy and Anheuser-Busch.
- Exxon, Alfresco. Large industrial win with services attached to implementation.
- SLB and American Airlines, Analyst1. Net-new logos in Houston and Dallas Fort Worth on a platform with no vertical reference at the time.
- Cloudflare expansions taken from departmental footholds to enterprise agreements at 115 percent of a \$1M number: SSM Health, Graybar, Mercy, Ascension and BJC.

ATTAINMENT RECORD

- Red Hat: three consecutive years above target, peaking at 160 percent against \$7M.
- Alfresco: 146 percent of a \$4M team target, \$1.5M carried personally.
- Couchbase: 135 percent of quota, pipeline up 45 percent to roughly \$4M.
- Gigamon: 125 percent of a \$750K regional number.
- Cloudflare: 115 percent of a \$1M number, partner-sourced revenue up 25 percent.
- President's Club at three employers.

VERTICAL DEPTH

- Telecommunications and carrier: AT&T, Lumen Technologies and CenturyLink, Sprint, WorldCom.
- Financial services and payments: Mastercard, Edward Jones, Arvest Bank, Alliant Credit Union, Fiserv, Ameriprise.
- Healthcare and payer: Centene, Ascension, Mercy, BJC, SSM Health, Anthem, Cerner, Express Scripts.
- Energy and utilities: SLB, Exxon, Xcel Energy, Ameren, FirstEnergy, OG&E, Entergy.
- Industrials, transportation and retail: Emerson, Graybar, Enterprise Holdings, American Airlines, Anheuser-Busch, Post Holdings, Panera Bread.

Public sector accounts came through the Alfresco years. Of the verticals your posting singles out as being of particular interest, telco, finance, health, energy and tech, I have carried every one.

WORKING DISTRIBUTED

I have worked remotely from the Central US for the whole of my career at Red Hat, Couchbase, Cloudflare, Gigamon and Analyst1, all of them distributed organizations. Regional travel is routine and international travel is welcome. As a founding contributor to the NWA Tech Summit and an active Walton College Alumni Association member, I stay in front of regional technology audiences.

TECHNICAL FLUENCY, EARNED HANDS ON

Twenty AI certifications earned across Microsoft, IBM AI Academy, LinkedIn Learning and AWS, plus the AWS Certified AI Practitioner credential. EasyGuitar AI is mine too, a SwiftUI app I built and published with no programming background behind me. Shipping something myself changed how I talk with engineers about build against buy.

PARTNER BENCH

WWT, originated during my Red Hat tenure and re-signed at two later employers. Optiv, GuidePoint, SHI, Flashpoint and Intel 471. Each one carries a named joint account plan and a pipeline number.

EDUCATION

University of Arkansas, Walton College. MBA and BSBA.